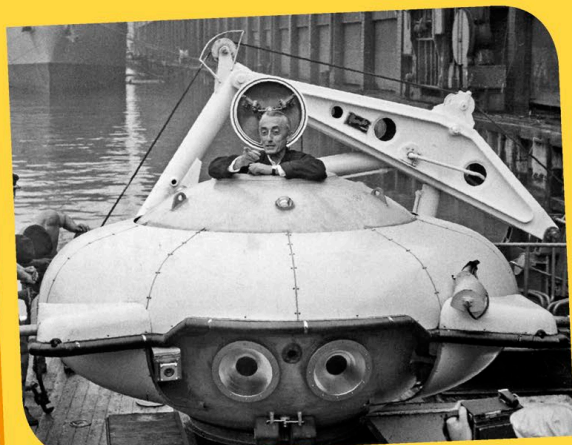


JACQUES COUSTEAU

French explorer Jacques Cousteau (1910–1997) designed and built scuba devices, diving saucers, and underwater work stations for scientists. His own deep-sea dives were caught on camera in movies and television series.



Cousteau on board one of his diving saucers

SYLVIA EARLE

American oceanographer Sylvia Earle (1935–present) built special diving equipment to discover new marine life and ocean features. She is committed to protecting the oceans and launched Mission Blue—an organization that creates marine protected areas around the world.



Earle showing her deep-sea exploration vehicle

Underwater explorers

The oceans remained a mystery until the 19th century, when underwater exploration began. The invention of submersibles (underwater vehicles) allowed scientists to visit the deepest oceans. Their research opened up the oceans as never before, but even today, only five percent of the world's waters have been explored.